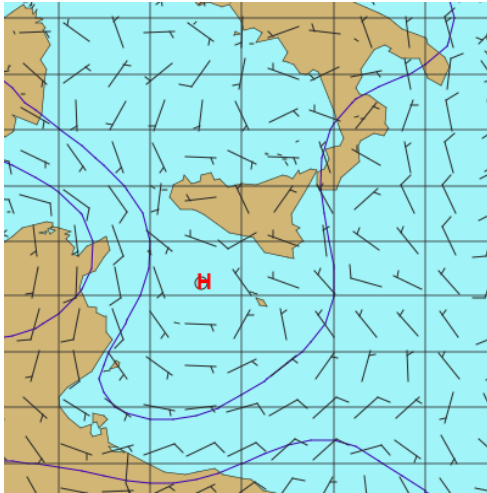


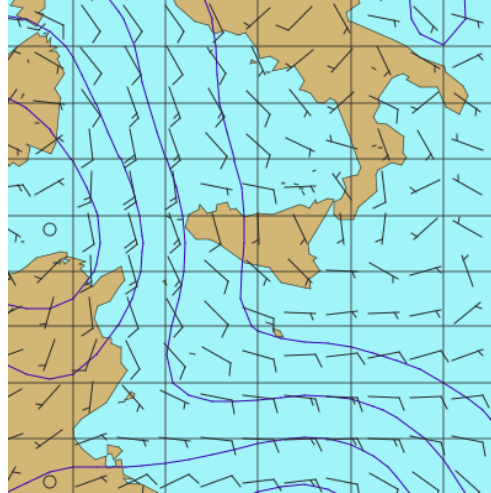
Date: October /17th /2015
Time: 09:45 AM (07:45 UTC)
Event: MIDDLE SEA RACE
Boat: ARTEMIS



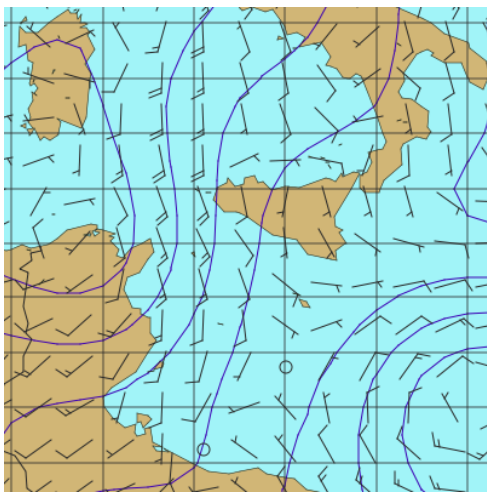
Synopsis: High pressures on the Tyrrhenian and Central Mediterranean on Saturday until Monday. Developing Low pressures south of Sardinia on Sunday and Monday, moving onto the Tyrrhenian Sea on Tuesday and to the Central Med on Wednesday. Associated Trough of Low pressures will sweep the region from W to E on Tuesday.



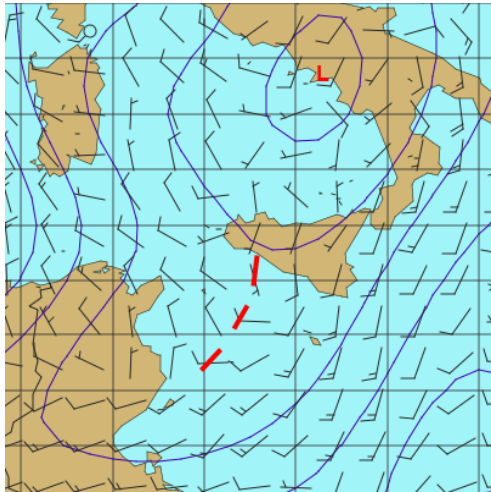
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sat 17th



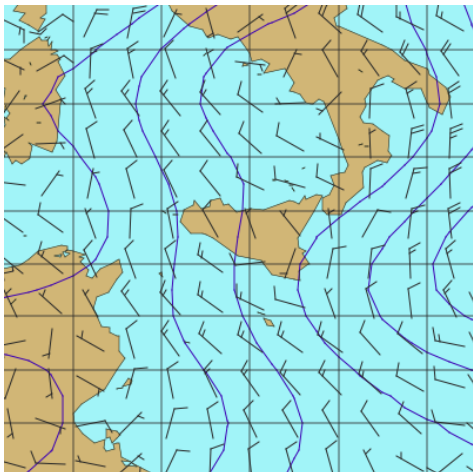
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Sun 18th



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Mon 19st



SLP FCST valid 12 utc Tue 20th



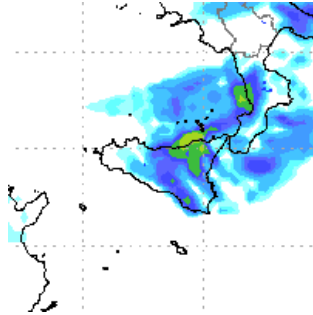
SLP FCST valid 12 utc Wed 21st

WARNINGS: Nil

Summary:

-High pressures and weak gradient apparently leading to a slow and long race until Sunday; moderate breeze increasing to strong on Monday to Wednesday, but difficult and very variable conditions in the last legs.

- Mostly sunny sky and mild temperatures until Monday, possible showers from Tuesday on, (but mainly over land and north of Sicily).



Precip Tuesday 17 h © Lamma

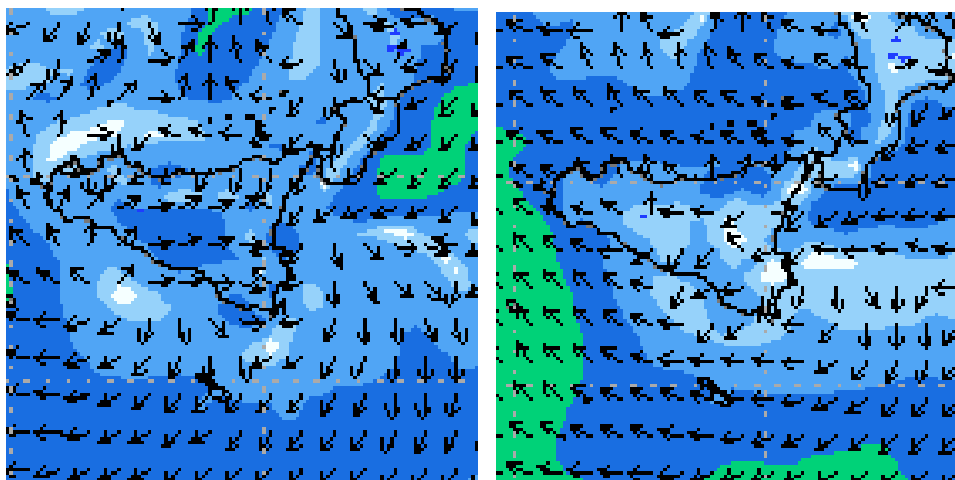
-Sea Surface Temperature along the Eastern Sicilian coast is around 23-24.

-Routings with our models are showing by the moment an estimated time of arrival on Wednesday early morning

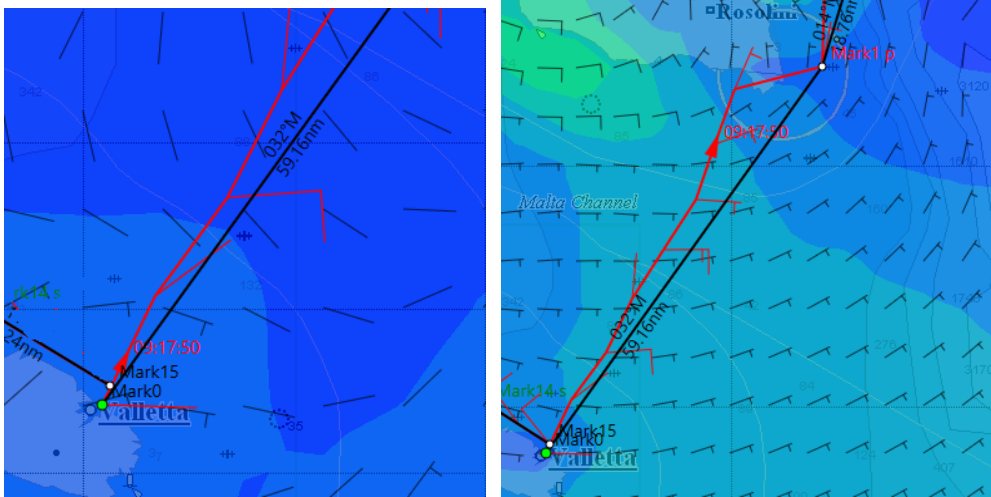
FORECAST ALONG THE COURSE

Malta to Portopalo (SE Sicily) 12-02h

Not well defined wind after the start, very light, there is can be a convergence zone between some light NW or N breeze and another one from E or NE. The convergence of the two winds NW and E will move from E to W, and might be visible by some low clouds. So the only rules for me are, 1. If sailing in NW or N breeze just sail the course to Portopalo (or close hauled on port). 2. IF sailing in very light winds, this should be the convergence area, try to get the new Easterly breeze first sailing more NE



Lamma, 17 and 23 h

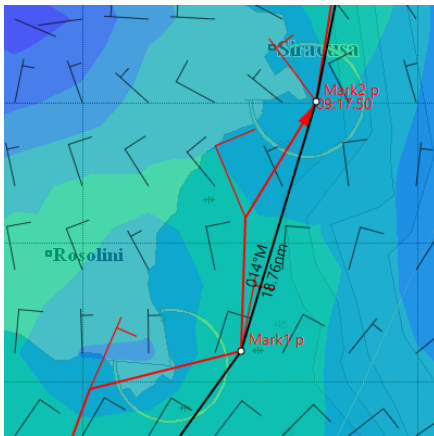


14 h and 23 h routes and wind fields, ALADIN model

Once in the new E breeze, it can be stronger on the southern course, our main scenario would be sailing a bit W of the course once in the E wind. Our scenario would be reaching Portopalo around 01-02 h.

Portopalo to Messina Strait 01-02 to 17 h Sunday 18th

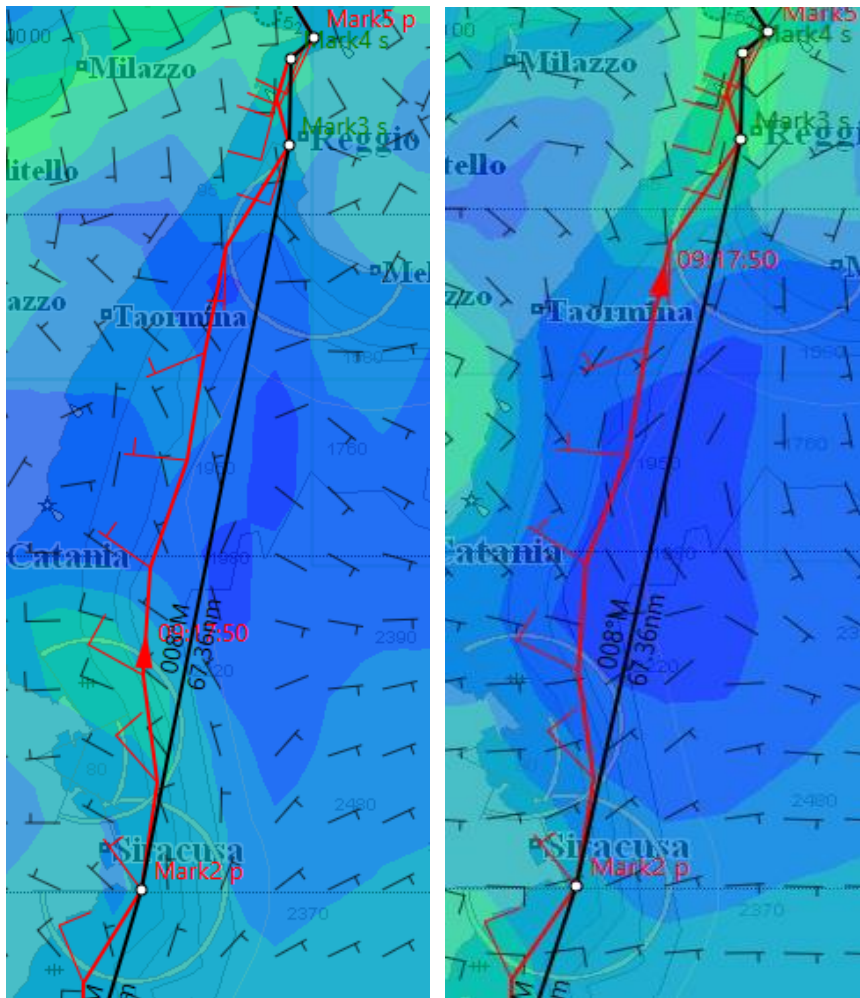
Land breeze bending around the SE coast of Sicily at night, you should play with the left bend but pressure differences (more pressure offshore and from the valleys):



Aladin route and wind field 05 h Sunday

My routing suggests a course a bit westward of the rhumb line, because it reaches the sea breeze of the channel around 14 h, but I think it's interesting to see the Sea Breeze at Catania. If you are later than this routing, the course will be better closer the the shore to get the stronger sea breeze, the earlier you are, the less needs for a sea breeze.

Routing with some other model has given a more direct option... I think I might work but it is more risky, chance of being parked with neither gradient nor sea breezes...



Aladin route and wind field 08 h

14 h

The afternoon and late afternoon would be a good time to reach the channel, enhanced southerly sea breeze there, 180-200°, 8-12 kts. Interesting to know the Tide times to decide the route:

The changes of tidal stream on Sunday are expected

Slack water: 12:14 h 19:05 h 22:57 h

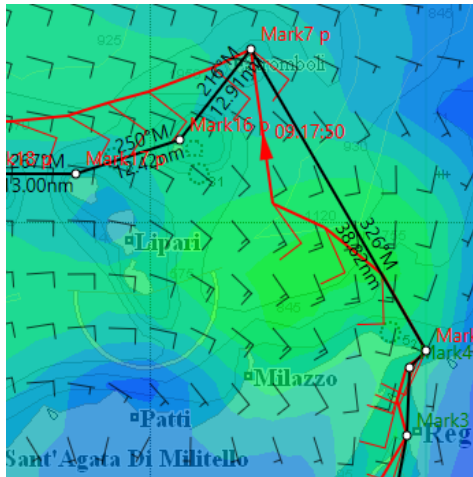
Southwards current (*scendente*) between 12:14 h and 1905 h, from 2257 to 0622 h (Monday)

Northwards current (*montante*) between 1905h and 2257 h.

<http://correntidellostretto.it/>

Strait to Stromboli 17 h to 21 h (Sunday)

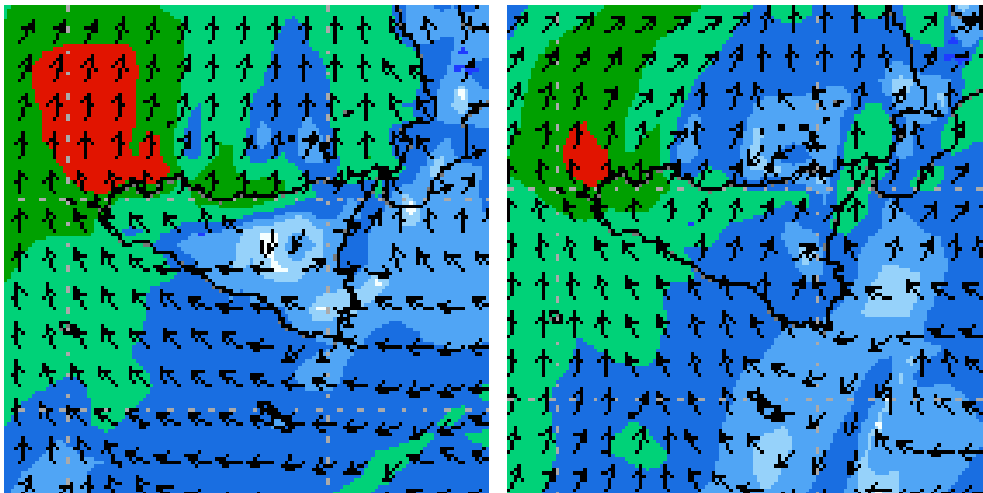
Good pressure expected on this leg until 16-18 kts, wind bending from 180-200 at the Strait to some 140-150 at Stromboli 8 more backed 110-120 if you reach there earlier than 20 h). Routing shows a gybe to play the bend, but watch out to get out of the pressure "tube", maybe not well reckoned by the model.



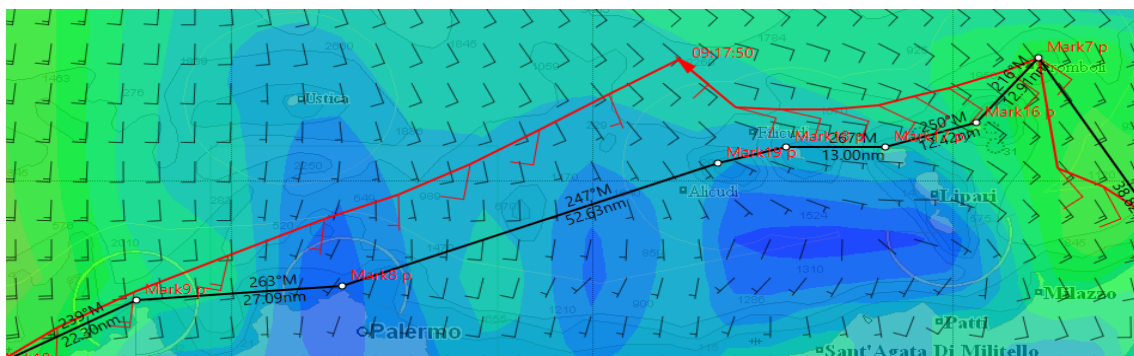
Routing and wind field at 20 h Sunday

Stromboli to San Vito lo Capo 21 h (Sunday) to 11 h (Monday)

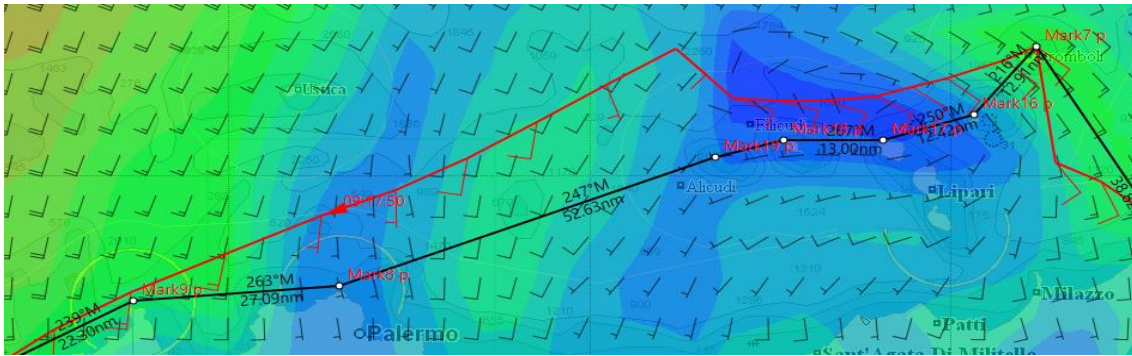
Southerlies prevailing on this leg, with some possible shadowed areas, and some possible backing to ESE in the beginning (go down in this case), veering to SSW in the last part of the leg. Our routing suggests a north course to avoid this shadow, but I think this will depend on the pressures you see on the course. Normally a course just a bit north of the rhumb line should be enough.



Lamma wind fields 05 h and 14 h



Routing and wind field ECMWF 02 h Monday

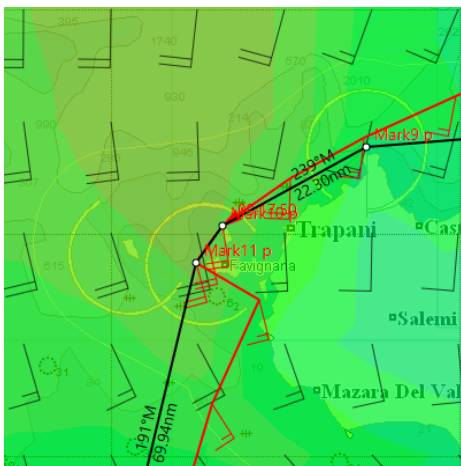


Routing and wind field ECMWF 08 h Monday

The rounding at San Vito could be trickier than the model shows, as the breeze there could be more veered, you could have to sail close hauled if going too far, but there can be some shadow too close. The earlier you reach there, the stronger the southerly breeze as you can see above on the Lamma maps. Possible 20-25 kts periods close to San Vito.

San Vito lo Capo - Favignana 11 h to 13-14 h Monday

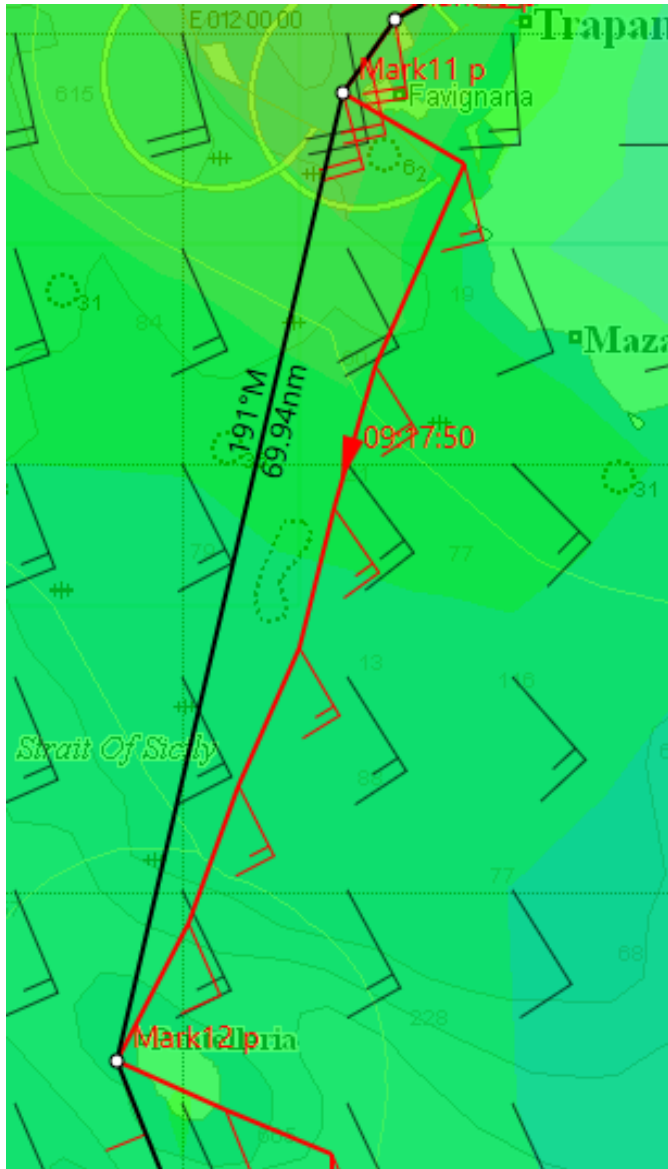
Strongest breeze of the race can be close to San Vito (if you are reach there in the morning) or in this short leg (if you get there around noon), expect some wind bending around the island from 180-190° at San Vito, to some 150-160° at Favignana.



ECMWF route and wind field 13 h

Favignana– Pantelleria

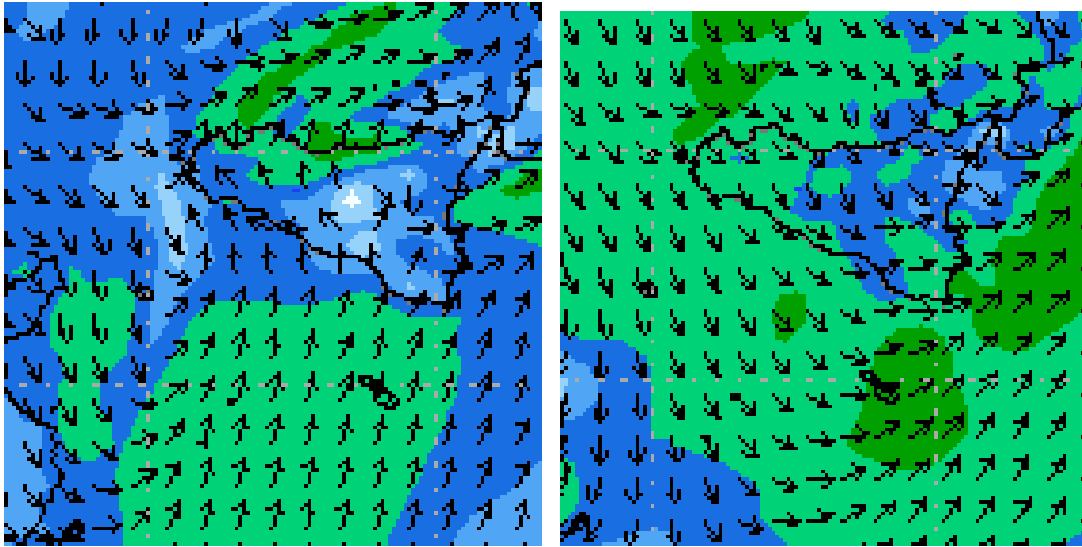
Our routing shows a tack shorewards, but it is playing a small wind bend around the coast, but the numbers are 160° at favignana to 150-155° at Pantelleria, so it is not so sure it pays...Easy leg apart from that, wind easing from 18-20 kts to 8-12 kts...



ECMWF route and wind field 17 h Monday

Pantelleria - Lampedusa – Finish

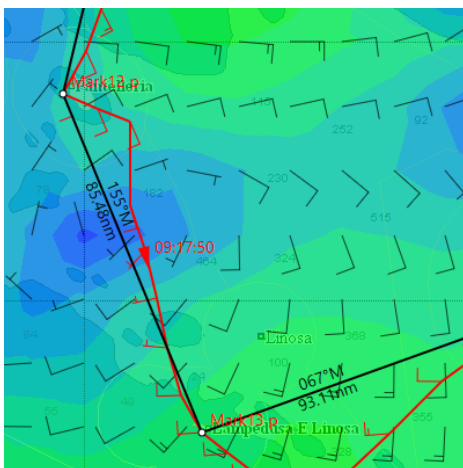
The confidence from this point on is very Low, as a Low centre can be just around the region on Tuesday early morning and morning. Let's see the big picture and options. Lamma shows the Trough with a convergence of winds between NW and SW,



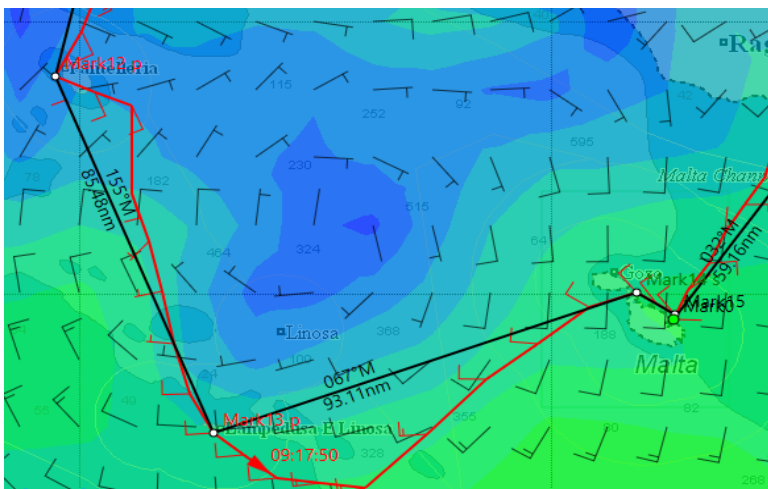
Lamma 08 h and 17 h

The difficult point would be in this case the earlier transition from SE to NW, then the second one is easy.

European model ECMWF shows a bit different pattern:



ECMWF 05 h



ECMWF 11 H

So the Trough according to ECMWF form a weak Low centre just in the middle of the course, winds rounding it along the laylines at some point.

I think the confidence is Low, but depending on the wind direction and speed you will be able to reckon the position of the centre and the distance to it. The low cloudiness can be a good help, showing any convergence of winds, or even the Low centre showing a darker and/or towering Cu at some region (apart from the land, where there will be there for sure).

In any case the final winning breeze is the NW, sweeping the SW from W to E, normally in moderate speeds or some fresh period.

My routing times according to ECMWF are 21-22 h (Monday) at Pantelleria, 10 h at Lampedusa and 21 h Tuesday finish.

Good winds and good luck!